World's largest battery built in Australia

Tesla chief executive Elon Musk has delivered on his promise of building the world's biggest lithium-ion battery in 100 days. Only 63 days after the contract between Tesla, the French renewable energy company Neoen, and the South Australian government was signed, the battery was linked to the grid. The 100-megawatt/129MWh battery will store power generated by a wind farm in South Australia, releasing it during times of increased demand. It is said to be three times more powerful than any current competitor.



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The battery has the storage capacity to support around 30,000 homes for over an hour. But, officials are hoping to further stabilise the system and ease power load during peak demand. The goal is to improve upon the grid to avoid such instances as the statewide blackout that left 1.7 million people without power in September 2016.

However, the battery may not remain the largest in the world for long. Currently, Hyundai Electric & Energy Systems is building a battery in South Korea to be activated in early 2018 that is 50 per cent larger than Tesla's.

Fully self-driving cars are here

Fully self-driving vehicles from Waymo—the autonomous vehicle division of Alphabet—are test-driving on public roads in Arizona, without anyone in the driver's seat. Till date, driverless vehicles have operated on public roads with a test driver at the wheel.

"This is the most advanced vehicle we have developed to date," said Waymo's CEO, John Krafcik. "Everything in it is designed and built for full autonomy. A combination of powerful sensors gives our vehicles a 360-degree view of the world. The lasers can see objects in three dimensions, up to 300 metres away. We also have short-range lasers that stay focused close-up to the side of the vehicle. Our radars can see


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